

Exercise Recovery Basics

Sleep and Recovery

Sleep is one of the most important factors in exercise recovery. During deep sleep, the body releases growth hormone, which supports muscle repair and tissue growth. Most adults engaged in regular resistance training benefit from seven to nine hours of sleep per night, with consistent sleep timing being nearly as important as total duration.

Active Recovery

Active recovery involves low intensity movement on rest days, such as walking or light cycling. This approach increases blood flow to fatigued muscles without adding significant additional training stress, which can help reduce the perception of soreness compared to complete rest.

Nutrition Timing

Consuming protein and carbohydrates within a few hours after training supports glycogen replenishment and muscle protein synthesis. Total daily protein intake matters more than precise timing for most recreational athletes, but timing can offer a modest additional benefit during periods of high training volume.